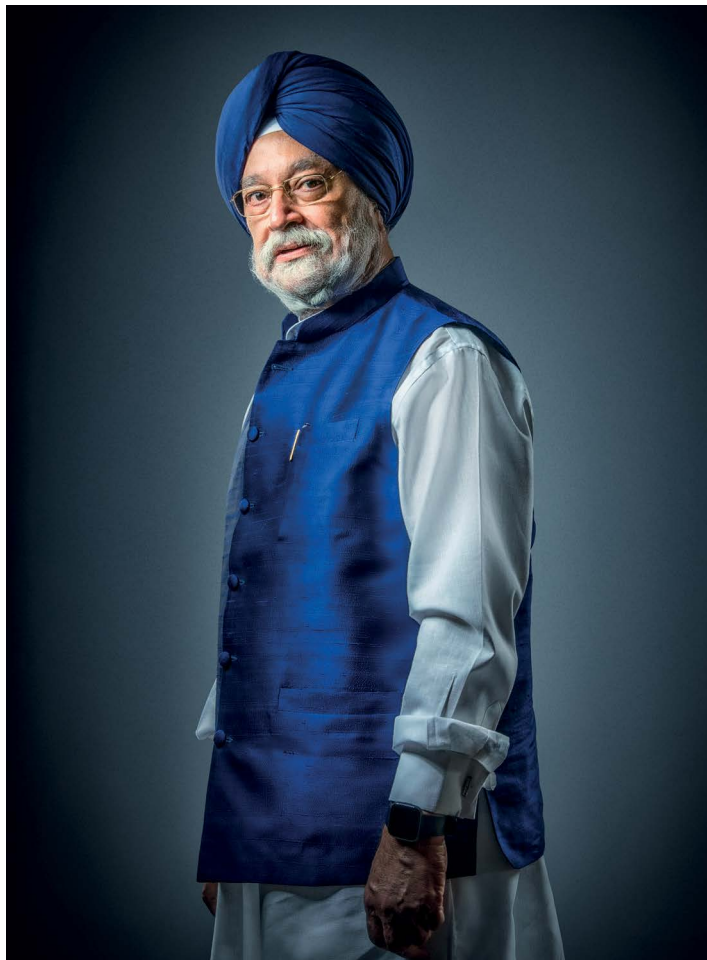


PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH



“INDIA HAS FEEDSTOCK FOR POTENTIAL PRODUCTION OF 19-24 MT OF SAF PER YEAR, WHEREAS THE ESTIMATED MAXIMUM REQUIREMENT OF THE COMMODITY IN INDIA, CONSIDERING 50 PER CENT BLEND, IS AROUND 8-10 MT PER YEAR BY 2030”

HARDEEP SINGH PURI
MINISTER OF PETROLEUM AND NATURAL GAS

that we are pushing the developments and logistics pipeline of synthetic fuels that are not derived from fossil fuel sources,” says Air India CEO Campbell Wilson.

But it was the Gurugram-based low-cost carrier SpiceJet that operated the country's first SAF blended flight in August 2018. The carrier has set a target of flying 100 million domestic passengers on SAF blend by 2030. “Aviation is a key economic enabler, yet increasing access to air travel and its benefits must not come at the cost of the environment,” says Ajay Singh, Chairman and Managing Director of SpiceJet. Besides, SpiceJet is also the first Indian carrier to use a taxi-bot for taxiing to the runway; it has also introduced electric tarmac coaches.

Akasa Air, the country's newest scheduled carrier, often likes to describe itself as “India's greenest airline”. It has taken several steps to reduce its environmental impact, including fuel-efficient engines on its fleet of Boeing 737 MAX aircraft, crew uniforms developed using plastic bottles salvaged from marine waste and eco-friendly in-flight meal packaging. “A key decision was to move away from the ceremonial water cannon salutes at flight and route inaugurations for management of water wastage, which has resulted in saving approximately 300,000 litres of water to date,” says Belson Coutinho, the airline's Co-founder and Chief Marketing and Experience Officer.

Besides, most major carriers are collaborating with the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Indian Institute of Petroleum (CSIR-IIP), Dehradun, for the research, development and deployment of SAFs. This programme's importance can be gauged from the fact that state-owned Engineers India (EIL) has also joined the SAF bandwagon. “EIL is playing a crucial role in providing technological solutions for decarbonising the aviation sector in collaboration with CSIR-IIP. In this regard, we are providing technology support and consultancy services for production of bio-ATF for Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals (MRPL),” says Vartika Shukla, EIL's Chairman and Managing Director.

The civil aviation ministry is simultaneously conducting an audit of airport assets to reduce the CO₂ footprint, with 11 airports in the private sector and close to 96 of the Airports Authority of India (AAI) to be completely carbon-neutral by the second quarter of 2025. Already, the privately managed airports in Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru have received the Airport Council International (ACI)'s prestigious level 4+ accreditation in the